

Sweat and smells

During puberty, the body produces more sweat, and more smells. As teens sweat much more than children, maintaining good personal hygiene will help to reduce self-consciousness about being sweatier or smellier than before.

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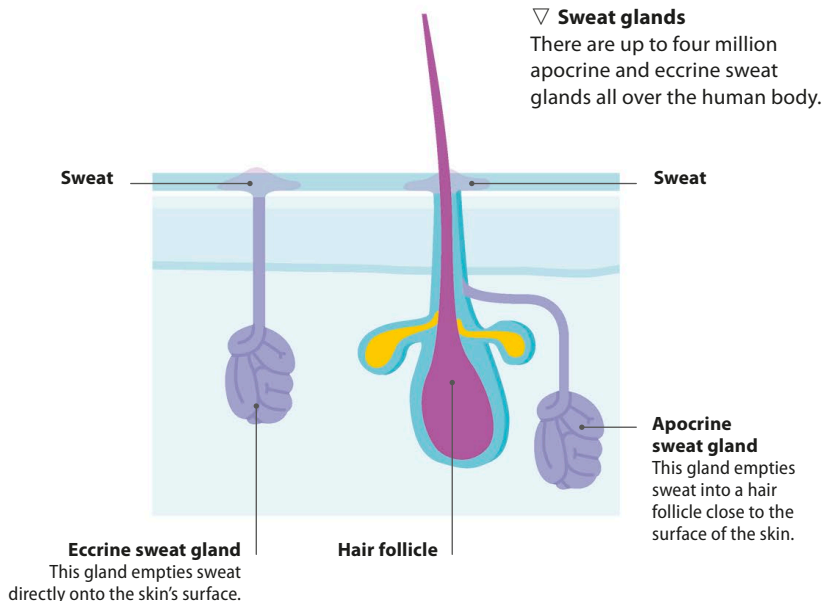
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Explaining sweat

Sweat is produced by two types of sweat glands, which are long, coiled tubes in the skin. Active from birth, eccrine glands cover most of the body and produce a clear fluid that empties directly onto the skin. As this fluid evaporates from the skin, it cools the body's temperature.

Apocrine glands are found in the armpits and genital regions. These glands produce a thick, milky fluid when a person is nervous or stressed. This substance is full of proteins that are broken down by bacteria on the skin, causing bromhidrosis, known as "body odor" or BO.



GOOD TO KNOW

Sweating

Sweating is caused by:

- high temperatures
- exercise and physical activity
- emotional distress
- eating hot or spicy foods
- hormonal changes.

Some people sweat more or less than others, and it's worth seeing a doctor if a teen is concerned.

Sweaty teenagers

The apocrine glands only become active once puberty starts, which is why teens find that they sweat more at this time. The hormonal changes of puberty can also make a person more sweaty. It can take a while to get used to sweating more and to learn how to deal with it, but it's important to remember that it's a natural bodily function. Whether a person's being active or inactive—everyone sweats throughout the day.



▷ Daily sweats

Some activities will make you sweat more than others, as will certain feelings, such as anxiety.